RUNNING BIT

Previously, at This Table

Recap small events from earlier as background to what's happening now.

RUNNING BIT

The Imaginary Shop

Invent an imaginary business selling something mentioned tonight and refer back to it when it fits.

RUNNING BIT

Tomorrow's Headline

Give minor events short, friendly headlines.

RUNNING BIT

The Committee

Mention an imaginary committee's opinions on trivial decisions.

RUNNING BIT

A Useful Motto

Invent a short motto and reuse it in later conversations, without asking anyone to repeat it.

RUNNING BIT

Unofficial Mascot

Give an object on the table a recurring role in your comments, without handling anyone else's belongings.

RUNNING BIT

Borrowed Wisdom

Treat someone's earlier throwaway remark as wise advice for a different situation.

RUNNING BIT

Infrastructure Enthusiast

Work the word "infrastructure" into unrelated conversations, no more than once per topic.

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RUNNING BIT

Quiet Footnotes

Add short, unnecessary clarifications to your own perfectly clear statements.

RUNNING BIT

Careful Conclusions

Present everyday opinions as cautious conclusions: "My current theory is..." or "The early signs are promising."

RUNNING BIT

Delightfully Underwhelmed

Praise things you genuinely like as if they're only mildly impressive.

RUNNING BIT

Domestic Metaphors

Compare unrelated situations to household chores, using a different chore each time.

RUNNING BIT

The Logistics Department

When plans come up, focus intently on one small detail: seating, snacks, luggage, opening hours.

RUNNING BIT

The Unappointed Critic

Give detailed, positive reviews of things nobody reviews: a spoon, the lighting, the bread arrangement.

RUNNING BIT

Future Museum

Wonder aloud what people decades from now will make of an object or custom mentioned tonight.

RUNNING BIT

Soundtrack Consultant

Suggest a soundtrack for situations people describe, without playing music or asking anyone to sing.

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RUNNING BIT

Everything Is a Design Choice

Guess why everyday objects or habits are the way they are.

RUNNING BIT

Local Guide

Describe details of the table or room as beloved local landmarks.

RUNNING BIT

Tiny Triumphs

Find tiny reasons for a toast or celebration. Raising a glass is enough; no drinking required.

RUNNING BIT

Future Tradition

Suggest making ordinary things that happen tonight into annual traditions.

RUNNING BIT

The Specific Compliment

Give oddly specific, sincere compliments about people's everyday choices, not their appearance or private lives.

RUNNING BIT

Quiet Fan Club

Show oddly specific enthusiasm for a preference someone mentions, without inventing a shared experience.

RUNNING BIT

Bridge Maker

Connect two different people's remarks as if their ideas obviously belong together.

RUNNING BIT

Collective Credit

Credit little successes to the group's teamwork, even when nobody had to coordinate.

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MISSION

The Echo

Introduce an expression that another player later uses in a different context, without asking them to repeat it.

MISSION

It Has a Name

Give a shared object or idea a nickname that someone else later uses without prompting.

MISSION

Return Ticket

Get another player to bring back a topic you introduced after the conversation has moved on, without reminding or asking them.

MISSION

A Shared Reference

Compare something tonight to a familiar fictional character and get someone else to reuse the comparison later, without prompting.

MISSION

Next Time

Get someone to suggest repeating a small part of tonight at a future gathering, without proposing a tradition yourself.

MISSION

Your Example, Their Point

Introduce a hypothetical example that someone else later uses to make a different point, without asking them to use it.

MISSION

The Callback

Get another player to joke about a detail from your story after the topic changes, without asking for a joke or repeating the punchline.

MISSION

Borrowed Recommendation

Get someone to pass your recommendation to another guest in their own words, without asking them to relay it.

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MISSION

Forecast

Get another player to say "umbrella" without saying it yourself, asking for the word, or starting a guessing game.

MISSION

The Scenic Detour

Get another player to say "shortcut" while discussing a task or journey. Don't say it yourself, ask for the word, or start a guessing game.

MISSION

A Familiar Feeling

Get someone to say "nostalgia" or "nostalgic" about a food, song, or object, without using or asking for either word.

MISSION

More Credit, Please

Get someone to call a food, object, or activity "underrated," without saying or suggesting the word yourself.

MISSION

The Exception

Get another player to say "it depends" in conversation, without saying it first or asking them to finish a sentence.

MISSION

Worth Asking

Ask a question that gets a "that's a good question" from someone. Don't say the phrase first or ask them to rate your question.

MISSION

A New Angle

Get someone to say "I never thought of that" without suggesting the phrase or asking them to repeat you.

MISSION

An Unexpected Turn

Get another player to say "plot twist" about a story or hypothetical situation, without saying it yourself or starting a guessing game.

50 mm - print at 100%

MISSION

Holiday Committee

Get two other people to suggest details for an imaginary group holiday, without proposing the destination yourself.

MISSION

A Matter of Principle

Get two other people to discuss a trivial choice, like bowls versus plates or window versus aisle. Both must give a reason.

MISSION

Opening Night

Get two other people to each suggest something for an imaginary cafe's menu.

MISSION

The Perfect Bench

Get two other people to agree where an imaginary park bench belongs, with a reason each. You can't suggest the spot.

MISSION

One Luxury

Get two other people to agree on one unnecessary comfort for an imaginary short trip. You can't make the final choice or call a vote.

MISSION

The Better Name

Get someone to invent a name for an imaginary restaurant, band, or boat, and someone else to say they like it.

MISSION

Gentle Redesign

Get two other people to suggest different improvements to an everyday object, without criticizing the venue or anyone's belongings.

MISSION

Unnecessary Ranking

Get two other people to agree on a top pick in a trivial category, like pasta shapes. Both must give a reason. No formal vote.

50 mm - print at 100%

MISSION

Human Diagram

Get someone to explain something using an object on the table, without suggesting props.

MISSION

The Shape of It

Get someone to trace a shape in the air while explaining an object, route, or idea, without requesting or demonstrating the gesture.

MISSION

Counting On It

Get another player to count at least three items on their fingers while making a point, without asking them to count or use their hands.

MISSION

A Small Toast

Get at least two others to raise a glass to a small, happy moment from tonight. No drinking required.

MISSION

The Sound Effect

Get someone to add a short sound effect to a story, without asking for a noise, impression, or performance.

MISSION

Look Again

Get another player to point out a nice detail of the table or room, without mentioning it first or asking them to look for one.

MISSION

Passing the Question

Get someone to ask another guest a follow-up question about a detail you mentioned, without asking them to pass the question on.

MISSION

The Joint Example

Get one guest to start an example and another to add a detail before you speak again. Don't ask either to finish the other's story.

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MISSION

Resident Expert

Get the person on your right to explain a niche interest, then get someone else to ask them a follow-up question.

MISSION

Origin Story

Get someone to tell how they first learned an everyday skill, without directly asking how.

MISSION

Unexpected Connection

Get two other people to discover a shared niche interest and swap a detail about it. Don't invent any experiences.

MISSION

The Useful Tip

Get someone to share a practical tip that another guest says they'd like to try, without asking anyone to endorse it.

MISSION

Small Victory

Get someone to tell how they solved a small household or hobby problem, including what finally worked.

MISSION

Two Versions

Get two other people to compare how they do the same everyday task and spot a difference, without announcing a comparison challenge.

MISSION

First Attempt

Get someone to volunteer a story about their first try at a hobby or recipe, including what they changed next time.

MISSION

The Recommendation Chain

Get one person to recommend a book, show, song, or recipe and another to add a related suggestion. No round-the-table lists.

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